

D916

MHA Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A capstone student at a 300-bed hospital with a new parking garage finds that 62% of discharges happen before 2 p.m., while leadership's target is 80%. Late discharges delay admissions from the ED. The CEO recently returned from a leadership retreat. Which problem statement is strongest?

- A. Discharges are always too late
- B. The hospital needs a discharge lounge
- C. Parking garage congestion is slowing discharges
- D. Only 62% of discharges occur before 2 p.m. versus an 80% target, delaying ED admissions

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A student proposes a fall-prevention program at a hospital known for its orthopedic wing. The program costs \$150,000 a year and is expected to save \$420,000 a year in avoided fall costs. The CFO previously worked in banking. What is the ROI?

- A. 280%
- B. 180%
- C. \$270,000
- D. 64%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Leadership requires at least a 50% ROI. A project will save \$300,000 a year. What is the most it can cost per year?

- A. \$200,000
- B. \$250,000
- C. \$150,000
- D. \$450,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A telemetry-monitoring upgrade at a hospital with a new rooftop helipad costs \$600,000 upfront and saves \$15,000 a month. The vendor is based in a neighboring state. What is the payback period?

- A. 40 years
- B. 40 months (about 3.3 years)
- C. \$9 billion
- D. 3.3 months

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project must pay back within 2 years and will save \$25,000 a month. What is the most it can cost upfront?

- A. \$12,500
- B. \$600,000
- C. \$300,000
- D. \$50,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

6.

Midway through a capstone project to cut ED wait times at a hospital that recently repainted its ED, the sponsor asks to add a redesign of inpatient bed management without changing the timeline or budget. The sponsor is well liked by staff. What is the best response?

- A. Accept it, since sponsors set the scope
- B. Refuse, since project scope may never change
- C. Take it through change control and show that added scope needs more time, more budget, or a later phase
- D. Accept it, because the sponsor is popular

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

7.

A clinic with a new mural in its lobby switched to check-in kiosks last month. Staff use the kiosks but still keep paper sign-in sheets at the desk just in case. The clinic manager used to teach high school. In Lewin's model, which stage needs attention?

- A. Change
- B. Unfreeze
- C. Start over, since any backup means the change always fails
- D. Refreeze: remove the paper sheets, update policy, and reinforce the new process

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Before introducing a new scheduling process, a leader shares data on long waits and patient complaints to build readiness. Which stage of Lewin's model is this?

- A. Evaluation
- B. Refreeze
- C. Unfreeze
- D. Change

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

To spread a new bedside-handoff tool across a 12-unit hospital known for its healing gardens, a student looks for starting points. Nurses on two units are eager to try new ideas and are widely respected by their peers. The CNO has 25 years of experience. Which adopter group are they, and how should they be used?

- A. Innovators
- B. Laggards
- C. Early majority; wait until every unit agrees
- D. Early adopters; use them as champions to influence other units

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A capstone student at a health system with a new downtown clinic has 10 minutes to present to the board. She has 25 slides of detailed methods. The board chair is a retired judge. What is the best structure?

- A.** Open with the recommendation, key data, cost, and ask; put methods in an appendix
- B.** Show all 25 slides so nothing is ever left out
- C.** Walk through the methods in order, then give the recommendation
- D.** Frame it as a legal argument for the judge

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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11.

A project at a hospital with a newly renovated chapel has these tasks: A (3 weeks) then B (4 weeks); in parallel, C (2 weeks) then D (6 weeks). Task E (1 week) starts after both B and D finish. The project manager is PMP-certified. What is the shortest possible project duration?

- A.** 16 weeks
- B.** 6 weeks
- C.** 9 weeks
- D.** 8 weeks

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In the same project (A 3, B 4, C 2, D 6, E 1 week; critical path C-D-E = 9 weeks), task A slips by 1 week. What happens to the finish date?

- A.** No change; A-B-E grows to 9 weeks, which matches the critical path
- B.** It slips one week, since any delay always delays the project
- C.** It slips two weeks
- D.** It finishes a week earlier

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A capstone student at a 300-bed hospital ~~with a new parking garage~~ finds that 62% of discharges happen before 2 p.m., while leadership's target is 80%. Late discharges delay admissions from the ED. ~~The CEO recently returned from a leadership retreat.~~ Which problem statement is strongest?

Target word: best problem statement **Decides:** Current vs. desired state with data and impact, no solution.

A	Absolute language	Vague and absolute, with no data or target.
B	Inverted operation	Names a solution instead of describing the problem.
C	Camouflage	The garage is unrelated to the gap described.
D	Correct	States current state, target, gap, and impact.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A student proposes a fall-prevention program at a hospital ~~known for its orthopedic wing.~~ The program costs \$150,000 a year and is expected to save \$420,000 a year in avoided fall costs. ~~The CFO previously worked in banking.~~ What is the ROI?

Target word: ROI **Decides:** $(\$420,000 - \$150,000) \div \$150,000$.

A	Dropped element	Divides savings by cost and drops the subtraction of cost.
B	Correct	$\$270,000 \div \$150,000 = 1.8 = 180\%$.
C	Adjacent category	That is net benefit in dollars, not ROI.
D	Inverted operation	Divides net benefit by savings instead of by cost.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

Leadership requires at least a 50% ROI. A project will save \$300,000 a year. What is the most it can cost per year?

Target word: maximum cost **Decides:** $\text{Savings} \div 1.5$.

A	Correct	$(\$300,000 - \$200,000) \div \$200,000 = 50\%$.
B	Confusion set	Subtracts a flat \$50,000 instead of applying 50%.
C	Inverted operation	Takes 50% of savings; that gives a 100% ROI.
D	Wrong stem number	Multiplies savings by 1.5.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A telemetry-monitoring upgrade at a hospital ~~with a new rooftop helipad~~ costs \$600,000 upfront and saves \$15,000 a month. ~~The vendor is based in a neighboring state.~~ What is the payback period?

Target word: payback period **Decides:** $\$600,000 \div \$15,000$ per month.

A	Confusion set	Mixes the monthly savings with a yearly unit.
B	Correct	$\$600,000 \div \$15,000 = 40$ months.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies cost by savings instead of dividing.
D	Wrong stem number	Divides the months result by 12 but keeps the label in months.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A project must pay back within 2 years and will save \$25,000 a month. What is the most it can cost upfront?

Target word: maximum cost **Decides:** $\$25,000 \times 24$ months.

A	Inverted operation	Divides the monthly savings by 2.
B	Correct	$\$25,000 \times 24 = \$600,000$.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses 12 months instead of 24.
D	Dropped element	Drops the months; uses only $2 \times \$25,000$.

6. Answer C Concept 4

Midway through a capstone project to cut ED wait times at a hospital ~~that recently repainted its ED~~, the sponsor asks to add a redesign of inpatient bed management without changing the timeline or budget. ~~The sponsor is well liked by staff.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: best response **Decides:** Scope, time, and cost are linked.

A	Dropped element	Drops the time and budget limits.
B	Absolute language	Scope can change through a formal process.
C	Correct	The triple constraint means scope can't grow for free.
D	Camouflage	Popularity does not change the constraints.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A clinic ~~with a new mural in its lobby~~ switched to check-in kiosks last month. Staff use the kiosks but still keep paper sign-in sheets at the desk just in case. ~~The clinic manager used to teach high school.~~ In Lewin's model, which stage needs attention?

Target word: stage needing work **Decides:** The old option is still available.

A	Confusion set	The move has happened; the gap is making it stick.
B	Inverted operation	Unfreezing comes first; staff are already using the kiosks.
C	Absolute language	Backups signal an incomplete refreeze, not failure.
D	Correct	Refreezing locks the change in place.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Before introducing a new scheduling process, a leader shares data on long waits and patient complaints to build readiness. Which stage of Lewin's model is this?

Target word: stage **Decides:** Creating readiness.

A	Adjacent category	Evaluation is not one of Lewin's three stages.
B	Inverted operation	Refreeze comes last, after the change.
C	Correct	Showing why change is needed unfreezes the current state.
D	Confusion set	Change is the move to the new process itself.

9. Answer D Concept 6

To spread a new bedside-handoff tool across a 12-unit hospital ~~known for its healing gardens~~, a student looks for starting points. Nurses on two units are eager to try new ideas and are widely respected by their peers. ~~The CNO has 25 years of experience~~. Which adopter group are they, and how should they be used?

Target word: adopter group and use **Decides:** Eager and respected by peers.

A	Confusion set	Innovators are venturesome but often less influential with peers.
B	Inverted operation	Laggards resist change; these nurses are eager.
C	Adjacent category	The early majority follows opinion leaders rather than leading.
D	Correct	Early adopters are opinion leaders who sway the early majority.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A capstone student at a health system ~~with a new downtown clinic~~ has 10 minutes to present to the board. She has 25 slides of detailed methods. ~~The board chair is a retired judge~~. What is the best structure?

Target word: best structure **Decides:** Senior audience, short time.

A	Correct	Executives need the bottom line first.
B	Absolute language	Too much detail buries the message.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the order executives need.
D	Camouflage	The chair's past career does not change the structure.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A project at a hospital ~~with a newly renovated chapel~~ has these tasks: A (3 weeks) then B (4 weeks); in parallel, C (2 weeks) then D (6 weeks). Task E (1 week) starts after both B and D finish. ~~The project manager is PMP-certified~~. What is the shortest possible project duration?

Target word: project duration **Decides:** Longest path: C-D-E.

A	Inverted operation	Adds every task as if all were in sequence.
B	Dropped element	Uses only the longest single task.
C	Correct	A-B-E = 8 weeks; C-D-E = 9 weeks; the longest path sets duration.
D	Confusion set	Uses the shorter path.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

In the same project (A 3, B 4, C 2, D 6, E 1 week; critical path C-D-E = 9 weeks), task A slips by 1 week. What happens to the finish date?

Target word: effect of the slip **Decides:** A-B-E becomes 9, equal to the critical path.

A	Correct	Path A-B-E had one week of slack.
B	Absolute language	Tasks off the critical path have slack.
C	Wrong stem number	Doubles the one-week slip.
D	Inverted operation	A delay cannot shorten the project.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	3	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	11	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Data-based problem statement	A strong problem statement states the current state, the desired state, and the gap with data and its impact, without naming a solution.	Writing the favored solution into the problem statement.	A choice among problem statements.
2	Return on investment	$ROI = (\text{benefit} - \text{cost}) \div \text{cost}$, expressed as a percent.	Dividing benefit by cost and calling it ROI, or reporting net dollars as ROI.	An annual cost and an annual savings estimate.
3	Payback period	Payback period = upfront cost $\div$ savings per period, stated in the same time unit as the savings.	Mixing monthly savings with years.	A one-time cost and a steady monthly or yearly saving.
4	Scope control and the triple constraint	Scope, time, and cost are linked; added scope requires more time or money, or a trade-off, through a formal change process.	Accepting new scope without changing time or budget.	A sponsor's mid-project request to add work.
5	Lewin's change model	Unfreeze creates readiness, change moves people to the new way, and refreeze locks it in with policies, removal of old options, and reinforcement.	Declaring success once the new process starts while old workarounds remain.	Staff using the new process but keeping the old one "just in case."
6	Diffusion of innovations	Spread change through early adopters, respected opinion leaders who influence the early majority; innovators are venturesome but less influential.	Starting with laggards or confusing innovators with early adopters.	Respected peers who are eager to try new ideas.
7	Executive presentation structure	Lead with the recommendation, the key data, the cost, and the ask, then give supporting evidence; keep detail in an appendix.	Walking leaders through methods in chronological order before the point.	A short time slot with a senior audience.
8	Critical path	Project length equals the longest chain of dependent tasks; delays on that path delay the project, while other paths have slack.	Adding every task's time, or using the shortest path.	Tasks with durations, sequences, and parallel paths.

Course scope (public description): MHA Capstone is the culminating course in the MHA program, providing an integrative experience with all competencies and assessment topics throughout the program. You will synthesize concepts from previously completed coursework and demonstrate an understanding of responsible practices to promote quality, optimization, and innovation within healthcare organizations. The capstone includes a student-designed project intended to illustrate your ability to envision the future and effect change within a healthcare organization. You are required to use data and research to identify opportunities for improvement or change for a healthcare organization and then visually present a solution for implementation. In addition, the capstone encourages work in the healthcare industry that will be showcased in the student's collection of work and help solidify professional relationships in the industry. There are no prerequisites for the course.